Template description

This PRD template follows the Product Brief template and describes the What of our product. In the template, each section includes **what it's for** and an **example**.

Example product used throughout: *Pulse* – a B2B SaaS tool that helps remote team leaders detect burnout risk using lightweight weekly check-ins and insights.

[Product Name]

[one-line description]

> A quick snapshot that helps any reader immediately understand what this product is, why it exists, and its current maturity.

Status: **Draft** / Problem Review / Solution Review / Launch Review / Launched

Last Updated: Date

Link to Product Brief: Product brief - template & checklist

Decisions history

> Key decisions that were already made regarding this product

DATE	Decision	Decided by

This template was inspired by the work of Kevin Yien and by the Product Hunt product team

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Gating checklist

Problem & Customer

We can clearly explain **who this is for and what problem we're solving**

The problem is real, urgent, and worth solving *now*

Evidence & Assumptions

- ☐ There is at least some evidence (users, data, sales, support, or informed founder insight)
- ☐ The biggest assumptions are explicit
- ☐ Confidence level is stated: **High / Medium / Low**

Success Definition

- ☐ We know how we'll measure success (at least one metric)
- ☐ We know what *qualitative success* looks like
- ☐ We know **when** we'll evaluate it

Focus & Tradeoffs

- ☐ Clear non-goals are defined
- ☐ We know what we are **not** doing in this phase
- ☐ Scope is intentionally constrained

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Solution Shape

- [ ] The solution approach is clear at a high level
- [ ] There is a smallest meaningful version we can shi
- [ ] Future ideas are clearly separated from the current commitment

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Experience Reality Check

- [ ] We can walk through at least one real end-to-end user experience
- [ ] Major edge cases and risks are acknowledged

Risks & Ownership

- [ ] Key risks and dependencies are visible
- [ ] Decision-maker and owner are clear

Alignment Decision

- [ ] Key stakeholders have reviewed this
- [ ] Open disagreements are documented
- [ ] Decision is explicit: **Proceed / Revise / Stop**

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Intro & Goal

Describe the pain we are trying to solve with this product, the relevant customer segment, the scale and the impact in 3 sentences max.

- Why does this matter to our customers and business?
- What evidence or insights do you have to support this?

Example

Remote team leaders struggle to identify burnout early because signals are fragmented across tools and conversations. By the time performance drops or people quit, it's often too late. Pulse helps team leads proactively detect burnout risk using lightweight weekly check-ins and actionable insights. This matters because burnout is now one of the top drivers of attrition in distributed teams.

Target users & use cases

Clarify who this product is for and in which contexts they will use it. This prevents building for "everyone."

Example
Primary user: Engineering team leads managing 5–15 remote employees
Secondary user: HR partners supporting multiple teams

Core use cases:

- Team lead reviews weekly burnout risk before 1:1s
- HR scans trends across teams to spot systemic issues

High-level approach

Describe the shape of the solution without diving into detailed features. Someone should understand the approach even if the details change.

Example
Pulse will act as a weekly feedback loop combining short employee check-ins, sentiment analysis, and team-level insights presented in a simple dashboard for managers.

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Narrative

Optional: Share (hypothetical) stories to paint a picture of what life looks like for customers today. Describe common and edgy use cases to consider when designing the solution.

Example

On Monday morning, Dana opens Pulse before her team's weekly sync. She sees that two team members show elevated burnout risk compared to last month. Instead of guessing, she adjusts her 1:1 agenda to focus on workload and support. Over time, Dana notices fewer surprises, better conversations, and higher team trust.

Goals & success metrics

Define what success looks like, both measurable (quantitatively) and immeasurable (qualitatively). These goals guide prioritization and tradeoffs.

Example

1. Reduce voluntary attrition in pilot teams by 15% within 6 months
2. Achieve weekly check-in completion rate of 70%+
3. Team leads report higher confidence in identifying burnout (qualitative)

Non-goals

1. *List explicit areas we do not plan to address*
2. *Explain why they are not goals*
3. *These are as important and clarifying as the goals*

Example

1. Pulse will not replace performance management tools
2. Pulse will not provide clinical mental health diagnoses
3. Pulse will not be used for individual performance evaluation

🛑 Do not continue if all contributors are not aligned on the problem.

🟢 Complete the following table with "signatures" from all reviewers to move on.

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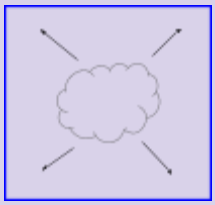
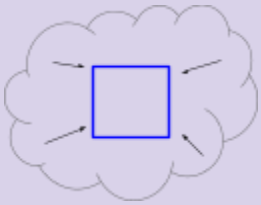
REVIEWER	TEAM/ROLE	STATUS

Solution Alignment

Define the perimeter of the solution. This is the commitment for the current phase.

1. *List the features that shape the solution*
2. *Ideally in priority order*
3. *Think of this like drawing the perimeter of the solution space*
4. *Draw the boundaries so the team can focus on how to fill it in*
5. *Link out to sub-docs for more detail for particularly large Products*
6. *Challenge the size to see if a smaller component can be shipped independently*

✅ *Draw the perimeter*	🚫 *Do not force others to identify scope*
	

Key Features

Example

1. Weekly 3-question employee check-in
2. Burnout risk scoring at individual and team level
3. Team lead dashboard with trends over time
4. Automated nudges for missed check-ins

Future considerations

Capture ideas that are intentionally deferred, without losing them.

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Example

1. Integration with Slack and Microsoft Teams
2. AI-generated coaching suggestions for managers
3. Company-wide benchmarks

Key Flows

Show what the end-to-end experience will be for customers. This could be written prose, a flow diagram, screenshots, or design explorations. It will vary by Product and team. Do not try to do this in isolation. Work with design and engineering to complete.

It is natural for this section to become more specific over time. It might start as a few annotated screenshots or stories. It might become highly detailed requirements with acceptance criteria. Adjust to the way your team operates. If you have a strong designer who enjoys going into every edge case, lean on them. If you have detailed engineers who prefer to have each scenario documented, go deep on acceptance criteria.

This will naturally change over time — that's okay. When changes occur, document them in the Changelog and notify all contributors.

Key Logic

1. *List rules to guide design and development*
2. *Address common scenarios and edge cases*
3. *It is often easier to write these out than rely on design to show every permutation*

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Priorities

Initial scoring of the main features planned for the product. This scores is based on the following guidelines

- **Reach** - How many customers will this project impact over a single quarter?
- **Impact** - How much will this project impact our company (i.e.increase conversion rate, $ size of the account) when a customer encounters it?
    - Massive — 3x , High — 2x, Medium — 1x, Low — 0.5x
- **Confidence** - How confident are we about the optimistic estimates for reach, impact, and effort?
    - High confidence — 100% - We did this exact project with minor changes
    - Medium confidence — 80%
    - Low confidence — 50%
    - Moonshot — 20% or less - We never did anything like it
- **Effort** - Estimate the total amount of time a project will require from all members of your team: product, design, and engineering. Estimated as a number of "person-months", or the work that one team member can do in a month.
- **Score** - (Reach * Impact * Confidence)/ Effort

Main feature	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Score

Resources

Describe which team and stakeholders will lead and decide on each of the product stages

Stage	Owner	Assigned (Y/N)
Analytics	Business analytics department	Yex
Citizens communication	Personal area manager	No
Market research	Labor department	Yes

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Launch Plan

Define the various phases that will get this product to market, the purpose of each phase, and the criteria you must meet to move on to the next one. Highlight risks and dependencies that can throw a wrench in timelines or progress (and ideally contingency plans). There is a table of example phases below.

Key Milestones

TARGET DATE	MILESTONE	DESCRIPTION	EXIT CRITERIA
MM-DD-YYYY	✅ Pilot	Internal testing with employees only	No P0 or P1 bugs on a rolling 7-day basis
MM-DD-YYYY	🛑 Beta	Early cohort of 20 customers	At least 10 customers would be disappointed if we took it away
MM-DD-YYYY	🛑 Early Access	Invite-only customers from sales	At least 1 win from every major competitor
MM-DD-YYYY	🛑 Launch	All customers in current markets	Measure and monitor

Operational Checklist

List the steps the stakeholders should take for a successful launch. For example, what website updates should we publish and what training should we provide to the team in order to support the product launch

TEAM (examples below)	PROMPT	Y/N	ACTION (if yes)
Analytics	Do you need additional tracking?		Work with [person] on logging
Sales	Do you need sales enablement materials?		Work with [person]
Marketing	Does this impact shared KPI?		Work with [person] on goal adjustment
Customer Success	Do you need to update support content or training?		Work with [person] on updates

Product Marketing	Do you need a GTM plan? (e.g. pricing, packaging, positioning,		Work with [person] with at least [x] weeks notice to kickoff workstreams
Partners	Will this impact any external partners?		Work with [person] on communication plan
Globalization	Are you launching in multiple countries?		Work with [person]
Risk	Does this expose a risk vector?		Work with [person]
Legal	Are there potential legal ramifications?		Work with [person]

Appendix

Changelog

List key decisions or updates you make for future reference. Include who was involved and link to notes doc, if relevant. Recommend moving this up top once approved so changes are more visible.

DATE	DESCRIPTION

Open Questions

Track open questions and answers here.

FAQs

Optional: Include an FAQ when helpful to answer high level questions so it is easier for people to grasp the point of the Product without getting lost in the details of product definition.

Impact Checklist

- Permissions
- Reporting

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- Pricing
- API
- Global

Reference documents

Add links to any documents that support this PRD like research, previous discussions, and other products